

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.03 Fire Prevention Plan

11/2023

Page2 of6

- a. Ensuring their employees receive initial training and annual refresher training on fire prevention and suppression techniques.
 - b. Maintaining a fire safe work environment.
 - c. Implementing the Plan's fire prevention and suppression standards as directed by the Fire Chief.
 - d. Working with their respective employees to identify, evaluate and control fire ignition sources.
4. Employees are responsible for working with their Captains in complying with the mandates of this Plan.
 5. The Training Officer is responsible for providing safety topics and materials on the subject of fire prevention and suppression for all departments to use in their safety meetings. Such topics are presented at least annually.

III. TRAINING:

1. As noted above under the subject of Responsibilities, the Calimesa Fire ensures all employees receive initial training during New Employee Orientation and annual refresher training via unit safety meetings regarding the fire hazards of the materials and processes to which they are exposed.
2. In coordination with the subject of emergency preparedness, the Training Officer also ensures employees receive initial training during New Employee Orientation and annual refresher training via departmental/division safety meetings regarding what they are to do in a fire. The Organization provides additional training whenever there is a change to the Plan.
3. The Organization trains and only permits authorized employees to transfer or withdraw flammable liquids. Such employees are trained on chemical safety, bonding, grounding and fire prevention.
4. All training is documented.

IV. POTENTIAL FIRE HAZARDS

Examples of potential fire hazards within Organization facilities include:

1. Overloaded electrical circuits.
2. Incorrectly wired electrical circuits.
3. Use of electrical extension cords as permanent wiring.
4. Inadequate protection of electrical cords from damage.
5. Accumulation of trash and waste.
6. Storage of combustible materials close to water heaters, furnaces, space heaters, hot

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.03 Fire Prevention Plan

11/2023

Page 3 of 6

- lamps, hot plates, hot irons, or outside close to buildings.
7. Improper storage of flammable liquids to include storing such liquids in unapproved containers, unapproved storage cabinets and in areas where ignition sources reside, such as in rooms with natural gas-operated water heaters.
 8. Lack of preventive maintenance and lubrication of machinery and equipment.
 9. Inadequately maintained heating, ventilation, and air conditioning systems.
 10. Open flames during welding, cutting, or brazing.
 11. Lack of a hot work permit program for times when hot work is done outside of the approved hot workshop.
 12. Smoking in unauthorized facilities and/or near flammable liquid storage or dispensing systems.
 13. Static electricity build-up during dispensing of flammable liquids.
 14. Use of space heaters without tip-over shut off protection.
 15. Lack of explosion-proof electrical apparatus in areas where there can be a buildup of flammable vapors.

V. PREVENTITIVE MEASURE - HOUSEKEEPING:

The Organization controls accumulations of flammable and combustible waste materials and residues so they do not contribute to fire ignition and conflagration. Housekeeping procedures include such activities as:

1. Daily disposal of trash from waste containers.
2. Immediately cleaning up and proper environmental disposal of all spills of flammable liquids
3. Maintenance of electrical equipment to include:
 - a. Keeping electrical circuits from becoming overloaded.
 - b. Requesting additional electrical outlets and power if needed.
 - c. Avoiding the use of electrical extension cords except for temporary usage (24 hours maximum).
 - d. Identifying problems with electrical wiring and outlets and making the necessary repairs.
 - e. Ensuring flammable vapors are kept away from electrical ignition points.
 - f. Not placing anything on top of electrical cords.
4. All use and storage locations (including tanks) of flammable liquids are properly posted, warning people in the area of the fire and explosion dangers.
5. Keeping the quantity of flammable liquids to a minimum to reduce the risk of fire. Only quantities of flammable liquids, permitted by the local Fire Marshal, are allowed to be stored within Organization buildings without being stored in a flammable liquids cabinet or a flammable liquids storage room.
6. Storing flammable liquids in UL-approved safety cans (made of heavy-duty metal construction with a self-closing spout and a flame arrester in the spout) and/or UL-approved flammable liquid cabinets, and in areas where there are no ignition sources.

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.03 Fire Prevention Plan

11/2023

Page 4 of 6

7. Keeping all containers of flammable liquids closed when not in use to prevent potential release of flammable vapors that could ignite.
8. Storing oily rags in UL-approved safety cans and in areas where there are no ignition sources.
9. Daily emptying of oily-rag containers.
10. Not storing anything in Heating Ventilation and Air Conditioning (HVAC) utility rooms.
11. Not storing any combustible materials within 36" of water heaters, furnaces, space heaters, hot lamps, hot plates, and hot irons.
12. Not storing any combustible materials within 36" of water heaters, furnaces, space heaters, hot lamps, hot plates, and hot irons.
13. Not storing pallets outside within 25 feet of any structure. Storing pallets, no higher than six feet high.
14. Only using space heaters having automatic "tip-over" devices that shut off the units in the event they should topple over.
15. Enforcement of the "no smoking" rule in all Organization facilities. Smoking is permitted only in designated areas.
16. Enforcement of the "no smoking" rule in areas where flammable liquids are stored or where flammable liquids are dispensed.
17. Maintenance of "smoking" areas to include placement of adequate receptacles.

VI. PREVENTITIVE MEASURE - MAINTENANCE:

In accordance with established procedures, the Training officer coordinates the proper maintenance of equipment and systems installed in the workplace to prevent accidental ignition of combustible materials and the immediate suppression of an incipient fire.

Examples of such maintenance include:

1. A regular schedule of ongoing preventive maintenance of machinery and equipment (including HVAC systems) to ensure inspection, maintenance and proper lubrication.
2. Maintenance of sufficient electrical power to handle each facility's and function's electrical needs, including areas where space heaters are used.
3. Checking electrical outlets and circuits to ensure they are correctly wired.
4. Ongoing maintenance of the Organization's Hot Work Permit Program to include a fire watch at all times open flames are present.
5. Following all safety precautions when welding, cutting and/or brazing.
6. Repair of identified electrical wiring and outlet problems.
7. Ensuring all electrical fixtures, switches, and circuits inside flammable liquid storage rooms are explosion-proof devices.
8. Maintaining all flammable liquid storage rooms with ventilation systems meeting National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) codes.
9. Maintaining a protected and ventilated dispensing area for filling containers with flammable liquids.

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.03 Fire Prevention Plan

11/2023

Page 5 of 6

10. Dispensing flammable liquids from drums using either a laboratory-tested hand pump or acceptable methods of gravity dispensing.
11. Installation and maintenance of explosion-proof electrical apparatus in areas where there is a potential buildup of flammable liquids.
12. Grounding of flammable liquid dispensing drums.
13. Bonding of flammable liquid dispensing drums to smaller flammable liquid containers to reduce the buildup of static electricity.
14. Using closed piping systems when pumping large quantities of flammable liquids.
15. Only using machines producing sparks (such as machines used for grinding, cutting, drilling, and sanding operations) in areas where there are no flammable or combustible materials.

VII. TYPES OF FIRE PROTECTION EQUIPMENT OR SYSTEMS:

Organization facilities are either sprinkled and/or have fire extinguishers in place for use at the start of a fire. Depending upon the facility, there are various fire and smoke detection systems used.

VIII. MAINTENANCE OF EQUIPMENT AND SYSTEMS:

Fire protection systems within the Organization are inspected and tested by authorized service contractors on a schedule established by the Fire Chief. Action is taken immediately if any system or part of a system is not working properly.

IX. INSTRUCTIONS TO EMPLOYEES:

WHAT TO DO IN THE EVENT OF A FIRE

In accordance with the Organization's Emergency Action Plan, employees call 911 first in the event they spot an incipient fire and initiate the Organization's emergency evacuation system.

Fire extinguishers are installed in Organization facilities in accordance with local fire code requirements, but employees are encouraged not to attempt to fight a fire. They are instructed to let Fire Department personnel fight the fire.

X. AVAILABILITY OF THE PLAN:

The Plan is available for review by all employees at the office of the Fire Chief.

**CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3**

Policy: 301.03 Fire Prevention Plan

11/2023

Page 6 of 6

XI. TYPES OF FIRE PROTECTION EQUIPMENT OR SYSTEMS

The Fire Chief annually reviews the Plan for completeness and accuracy, and makes any necessary revisions to the Plan.